

RENANCE

UNIVERSITY OF PORT HARCOURT

POL 101 — Past Questions & Materials

by Renance

Course: POL 101

Institution: University of Port Harcourt

Papers in this pack: 1

Levels: 100

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Paper 1 of 1 — Introduction To political science POL101.1

Level 100 • First Semester • PastQuestion

Political Analysis (POL 7 2.1

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Controversial, The pele a revenue from the Federay a

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Y decree under aj Jc formula evolved at Various times by 2 1 ee

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Methods adopted f Which combine to m i " ria is a system

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er introduces a formula that best Serves his interest. eS

ice Dependence :

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to mote. that the exclusive fed

resources apply only to oil and gas, and not to cocoa, palm oil, bitumen etc. This is the core of the agitation of the people of the South-South region. Dependency on a particular sector of the economy does not lead to proper utilization of other resources. Other resources / sector should be considered for the 15-4 sectors / subsets that make up the system, Nigeria.

eral jurisdiction over a natural

d. Corruption: Poverty persists in Nigeria due to the mismanagement of resources and corruption, found particularly but not exclusively in the public sector. There has been widespread of political corruption whereby those in office use their political power for financial gain. This affects resource control and thus retards economic development thereby affecting the system as a whole.

tards

No. 2. Differentiate between

between power and legitimacy show

7 why they

are considered as political concepts.

b) Difference between power and legitimacy and why they are political concepts:

1} POWER:

Power relations are the

Most significant aspect of a political

@ phenomenon that distinguishes

politics from other human activities.

around which any meaningful definition of politics revolves, it is a

what constitutes political analysis. Power is to be prized highly

as it improves one's actual or potential possession of other values.

system. Power is a '

Power is one concept

fundamental

because the possession

H) Power as a political concept does not have an absolute here

agreements on a particular definition of Power. According to Richard Pious (1986)

HW "Power is the capacity of an actor to get others to do what he wants

by means of subtle or overt pressure on

others to do by

including even the use of force". Alapiki (2010) defines it

as the ability to get others to do what

sanction, if and when necessary,

hence the definition as there are

es tas

at one warits them to do base on the use of threat or

y Accorcing to some scholars, the exercise of power applies some

Sanctions can be negative or positive

a instance, imprisonment is'a n

cash gift can also serve as ap

, form of sanc

as seen In the form of Punishment or

egative form of sanctions, while th

ositive sanction.

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; n of | A.nation is made up of no

eis ey ie or characteristics and united by common

| homogenous state ;
 erence | rare A nation may not necessarily be; for a nation to
 be sovereign it must be independent and have
 : the power to make and enforce laws. a
 is

: No. BS What do you understand by the structural functional
 . approach? Show how it can be applied.

al functional approach is : Answer

David Easton is greatly associated "With Gabriel Almond "his work, (which is a
 'comprehensive analysis 'of structural functionalism. It is an offshoot of
 general systems theory (approach). The
 : political system has structures and that these

According to Almond and Powell, every political

Structure is there to perform certain functions.

1 Structure refers to the arrangements within a political system through which action or
 is performed.

"observable activities take place. a

2 Function according to J. Easton is a condition or state of affairs that results from the working
 of the structure. A function according to Almond is objective consequence of action within the
 system, which results in most cases to the maintenance of the system.

Political scientists have identified two types of functions of a political system. 1. P

» Input functions: The input function deals with formation and transmission of 4

demands and supports, The input functions are non-governmental functions because
 they are not performed by the government or its agencies. 2. E

' The input functions are: - 1. 4

Political socialization and recruitment, socialization is process of inculcating values ;
 and norms and patterns of behavior appropriate for a political system. Political recruitment
 is the process of filling up political functions. © :

= Interest articulation: the process of formulation of demand. It is the ability to gather
 the interest of various individuals or groups or bringing together of the needs and interest
 of groups and presenting it to policy makers or government for formulation and
 implementation.

- Interest aggregation; collation of demands or combining demands into a
 purposeful action, 1

* Political communication: The channeling of demands through 1. r

2. A relevant appropriate media for

effective decision making. It is the transmission of ideas, values and norms from
 groups or issues that relates to politics or communicating the above activities within (the
 political system and from that to other subsystems,

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pie 'in the alg TD ce a wae reasons:

ymo. can be traced to two Greek words Demos and Kratien which me.

tule respectively. Therefore it is rule by the people.

Types:

Direct democracy: where eve

opinions are gathered and use

e best of

nd the be

ryone is given the opportunity to air one's view

as the opinion of the society.

Representative Democracy: a situation whereb

for or defend the views of the p

Major characteristics

~ Participation; there should be effective

decision Making process as regards to issu

Issue of equality: everyone shou!

given equal Opportunity to Particip,

> Accountability: th

5 sen to stand

Y an individual or a group is chose

eople or the whole society.

yd Le

Participation of individuals and groups

es that affect their lives. » should be

ld be seen as equal before the law. Everyone shor

ate in the political Process.

'nee their wy

: ere should be checks and balances; people should give aes ia Lic a

' dealings. There should be System of accountability whereby the behavior of leaders : a
| ' officials can be Monitored, judged and if necessary changed by the subjects of a state |
rae | Woe

ie Other features are: os

- Periodic election: elections must be

held at regular intervals

'he eyes of the law,

must be free from an

Rule of law: all citizens

4 - Independent judiciary:

legislature,

- Organized o

Working of the

elections and should be free and fair.

No one is above the law.

¥ Control of the executive or the

are equal in rights

* Judiciary must

Party keeps an eye on the policies and

evaluate Policies of the government, it

Ind frame policies for the future 2 pe 2

not from being dictatorial, for example at the Se 4

government to make,

government

Prevents the

TY Citizen is not u

Sually given eg

to employment OF j

>Portunities

> isp

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king power is subject to the rule of law and uses

the rights and freedoms of}

the leaders and on the extent to which the will of @ majority can be exercised against

rights of the minority. The rights include privacy, freedom of speech, assembly and religion

'etc. In liberal democracies rights are also referred to as liberal rights.

The socialist / communist variant:

It emanates from Marxian view.

the proletariat (working class i.e.

i working class could achieve

Power through democratic electi id the right to revolt if Uiere

denied political expression.

The third world variant: (The African democracy) There is high rate of poverty in

African. One distinguishing feature of Africa Is the care for brothers and sisters; they are

concerned about the welfare of their people. This commun

al care leads to communal interest;

and that is the definition of democracy,

(3b) Is Nigeria Practicing a pure form of Democracy

Refer to 2013 question for solution (No. 6).

(4a) What makes a over iti

Before explaining what make e ies legitimate?

ebour, Sa government legitimate, lets us define what legitimacy is all

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/ is exercised

it has a power to govern with a

- AS a political concept, legitimacy is

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RE GRoup; a lay 'an important role in, caret

Pressur groups are Group of persons who fess with such term as luntary

If Politics, The term, Pressure Group can be used DCRR ea CheMpS cls verouedths

Groups o Geeanized: intereate. Ehrman (1972) Cae of a particular interest. asis and

ASSOCialiong of individuals who band together for the defens: Il share common intere: rawr

Groups can be defined as prganizations whose 'members a ls.E.g. of pressure g

Seals, ang they wish 4 in vernment to attain these goals.&.

includes cademic Stare Union for

Students (NANS),

ciati Nigerian

Universities (ASUU), National Association of

Nigeria Bar Association (NBA) etc,

Af

Organized

Functions OF pressure Group ' ee

Itorest articuno? means they express the views and represe

SPCCializer) Sections of Society,

hey also Prov

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Opinion ON Crucial Matters,

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'ibutes, the allocation of values (preferences) May "0

Harold Laswell defined politics as "who gets what, when and how." this definition reflects the elements of power, authority and decision "making (note: what constitutes politics includes power, authority and legitimacy). These elements results in allocation of 'what' to the 'who' and by 'means and process 'how' as det ined by anti

5). Politics deals wi 1

and exercise of power, pa!

itous and'can be found in almost every human organization. It affects

is ubiqu rge

ee J heir daily activities. In other words, it is central to almost

people in diverse ways in t

all human affair.

organized groups. The ideas of family, state and country ganization. Without some form of organization, politics can

| Politics takes place in

connote some form of or:

hardly take place.

Di

Mice s. dy of politics. It 8 an intellectual discipline that

Political science is the systematic study of po itics. It.is an intellectual discipline tha studies political life. Some scholars defined it-as the study of government or political 7 institutions through which political life is exercised or expressed. Political science is also scen as a theoretical discipline which studies the form of the government and its working under a particular historical condition or perspective.

Political science is an academic discipline that is concerned with systematic study and analysis of politics. It attempts to understand the political behavior of individuals, groups and societies, factors that affects political life, political events and institutions.

le functions / important of politics includes:

Political science educates the citizens

It prepares students for certain career

provides academics and professional training for public service both In federal

| state level,

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 4 d Classification of data
 Crea Ng hypothesis
 Testing of hypothesis
 Creating of laws
 Verification of laws
 Acceptance of laws as theories,
 iti ience tr ience.
 Problems of applying ecigntific method to political aa political scien
 -" The Subject matter Of politics:Man is the subject ee ae
 Man cannot be manipulated like physical and chemical sci emment (Ss suMre
 Problem of ©xperimentation: Political Scientists cannot Neuer
 matter (man) just as experiment can be done in the natural s
 iberately disrupt
 Hurnan beings cannot be predicted accurately; they can deliberately
 Prediction,
 IS are subject to change,
 Human bein,
 Or is too elusive
 Human behavi
 In reality, political
 F} physical Science:
 Pcrpetually unc!
 » Subtle and complex. el Ta the
 Science cannot attain same Scientific status like we hav
 S. Political sciences has few certai
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 Despite alf the:
 'Se WE Can Sstilf Conclude that there js 4 science of politics Since science
 can be defineg as an accumulation Of sysi
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 and experience by man,

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by the citizens or

, it is legitimate. A government is said to

ce after fulfilling the laid down clearly defined an :

come to power through constitutional means or genuinely accepted

. For instance an elected government could be considered legitimate while

an unelected government could be seen as illegitimate. Notwithstanding legitimacy

can be acquired through popular government policies.

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\Superanus' w!

derived from the_L: word ch

Sncept of sovereignty, Is "concentr

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'ec. Sovereignty is the supreme power o

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din (1530-1596) a French

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re holder of power

vereignty is an essential

Per seolite supremacy, Which is not be red with others.

sons, state or any other authority. In 4

; it cannot be

Sovereignty may be in a person, a body of per!

unitary state, sovereignty can be located in a body. In a federal system

Types of sovereignty include:

independence from external _control. An

-, 'nal_ove' : This refers

external ian state can interact with other countries on equal basis. Every

independent state is at liberty to determine its forel joi

nt s gn policy and to join any block

of power it le i i i i

meter likes. External sovereignty in other words simply refers to national

4 Legal sovereignty: this refers to the

a persons or body of person and institution

"who has the power to make and enforce obedience to the Law; i.e. The legislative

Executive and the Judiciary and other agencies.

6 Political sovereignty: This is \

\gnhyi This type of sovereignty resides in the people of a country

@ Domestic sovereignty! this is (

: it is to do with the absolute

' absolute or overwhelming

perpetual power and authority of a state over the citizens and subjects :

has coercive or supreme power over citizens and territory. ACCORDING to

| : Pre-Me |. OVO! Use

| its basic laws or constitution. So >

CONCERT

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12) culminate in students

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ed an individual is the

ct of government in the society,

political information, _

ons @n a wider range of political subjects,

considers himself more capable of influencing the government

re likely to express confidence in his environment.

nt,

mate ties-

er group: group of people having similar status and interests. Boer political

media: newspaper, television, magazines is a great source of

socialization. ee

work place and other agencies such as religious groups, youth organizations,

girls' guide, clubs, political parties.

STATE AND NATION

detailed explanations of the two concepts

le past questions solution.

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S s'

supreme over every other organization/body in a given

ive power which clea

any other organization, = power and not subjé

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refer to

Past questions

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bout political objects / issues. r 3

ICY APPROACH Thi ee ae

ency theory is a neo-Marxist theory (i.e. an offshoot of the Marxist teow

merges as a result of the reactions to the inadequacies of aa ;

leory. The Modernization theory assumes that economic, social and

il backwardness of the third. world countries occurs due to their traditicus, It

izes that for them to grow they have to abandon their traditions and adopt the.

and programmes of the developed countries. In other words they should live and

he people of the developed countries. BY

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a

s widely accepted that no country or economy operates in autarchy in the modern *

wi a or economy is an island unto itself as they are increasingly becoming —

independent } pee

& 'gt a

|Neo-Marxist defined dependency as a situation in which the economies of certain

countries are conditioned by the development and expansion of another economy to

ich the former is a subject. Under this condition, the dominant economy (those of the

ustrialized capitalist state) expands and grows or develops while the dependent

conomies of the third world countries (non industrialized countries) referred to as the

jphery countries can only expand and grow as a reflection of the expansion of the |

(the industrialized state). This relationship prociuces under development:

dependency theorist focus their analysis on capitalism as a world syst 2m

y placed the less developed states of the world at the: peri

determined division of labour. Z

inctional approach

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S (the bourgeois)

| According to him the history of all previous hu

Man goes through five stages.

| Primitive communism +

Slavery

Communist state

Primitive communism: in this stage, technology (forces of production) is so primitive that people produce barely enough for their survival. Everyone has to work, no surplus product, there is common property and there are no classes. They live a communal life, :

Slavery Stage / phase: Successor to the communist stage. The

introduction of Private Ownership of Property and improved Production facilities. Her master determines decision making, the Society splits into the class of exploiters and the exploited (the slave masters and the slaves), The exploiters become the ruling class. These two classes brought an end

to the feudal lords (exploiters; ruling class)

5. Feudalism is a higher stage

than slavery as ne

The French / American bourgeoisie

has

this stage supersede